

Google and Deloitte expect India's quick-commerce market to reach \$250 billion by 2030 and as of April this year, the industry was estimated to be at \$50 billion. And the opportunity extends far beyond the current quick-commerce basket.

India's online grocery market was worth around \$12 billion in 2025, according to Ken Research, and is projected to reach \$103 billion by 2030. Overall grocery has the potential to touch the \$1 trillion mark by 2030. Yet online grocery accounts for only 1-2% of urban grocery consumption. That means the industry's biggest advantage may also be its biggest challenge considering that there is an enormous market still waiting to move online.

Goyal from Prosus believes the opportunity remains largely untapped. In urban centres, he says, online grocery—including quick commerce and other online models—accounts for only 1-2% of the grocery market. A large section of consumers continues to buy groceries the traditional way.

From a market perspective, therefore, the industry has only scratched the surface.

But Goyal's more important point is what comes next. "The question is not whether the market can grow; it is whether the economics that work in mature urban dark stores can be replicated across a much larger network," he says.

SIX PLAYERS, SIX DIFFERENT PATHS

The market may be enormous, but the companies chasing it are entering the next phase with different starting points, and different problems.

Instamart is recalibrating after a period of aggressive expansion, while Prosus is signalling that the business is unlikely to return to a growth-at-all-costs strategy.

"Instamart had the capital, but it could not scale fast enough, and that is where it lost market share to Zepto. Now its stated objective is to take back Zepto's share in the next two to three quarters. But the bigger question is whether it can do that while improving its unit economics. The pressure to grow and the pressure to become profitable are now coming together," says Meena.

Zepto has focused on value-conscious consumers while continuing to push scale. But it has also put its IPO plans on hold amid questions around valuation and profitability. Flipkart Minutes and Amazon Now are still trying to persuade consumers to switch from incumbent platforms. That makes customer acquisition critical and expensive.

Kunal Gupta, Senior Vice President & Head of Flip-



APOORVE GOYAL
MD, INDIA
INVESTMENTS,
PROSUS



Quick commerce is an inventory optimisation game as much as it is a cost game... Unit economics for a dark store depends on its size and several other factors, but inventory is a critical part of it"



RAHUL TANEJA
PARTNER,
LIGHTSPEED
INDIA



At different stages, investors have a different lens to investing. At Zepto's stage today, the question is: can you demonstrate profitability while scaling? At the current stage, that is what investors want to see"

kart Minutes Business, says the platform brings the wider Flipkart ecosystem—its technology, supply chain, customer base and assortment—into quick commerce. Gupta argues that Minutes' advantage is not simply its store network but the ability to combine Flipkart's customer base, supply chain, technology and assortment with a growing quick-commerce footprint.

"Minutes has scaled to 1,000 micro-fulfilment centres across more than 130 cities and 8,000-plus pin-codes in under two years, with order volumes growing fivefold over the past year," he says. It is leveraging the broader Flipkart customer ecosystem rather than relying solely on fresh customer acquisition.

Amazon Now has a unique advantage: deep pockets